

Software

Though not as important as the hardware, the software does come into play if you plan on using the webcam in ways that aren't traditional. Webcams come with simple image filters like the ability to apply sepia or inverting colours. What you need is a webcam that comes from a reputable manufacturer, this way you can be assured that there will be third-party software available that can use your hardware with ease. Some cheap brands tend to have drivers available only for Windows and no other operating system and since they aren't popular the chances that you'd find a community made driver for that model is remote.

Security concerns

While a webcam can double up as a home security device with the majority of the models coming with motion sensing capabilities there is also a rising concern regarding privacy. Malware unleashed by hackers and also by government security agencies have been known to remotely activate your webcam and transmit without your permission.

What to buy

When looking to buy a webcam keep the following points in mind.

- 1 High resolution must be accompanied by frame rates above 30 fps.
- 2 Pick a webcam with glass lens over plastic lens.
- 3 A good base/stand/grip is absolutely essential.
- 4 The versatility of the webcam depends upon the software suite that accompanies it.

Computer Audio

The personal computer is pretty much incomplete without a set of speakers. Whether you prefer to listen to music or simply teleconference, a set of speakers are an absolute must. Computers these days have an ample amount of audio output ports so you can hook-up your speakers on the front or at the back. However, the average computer speaker isn't going to give you great sound quality and if sound quality is something that you are a stickler about then you probably don't need to be reading this section anyways.

You can get speakers and microphones separately or you can combine the two and get a headset. It's your choice, however, the common trend is